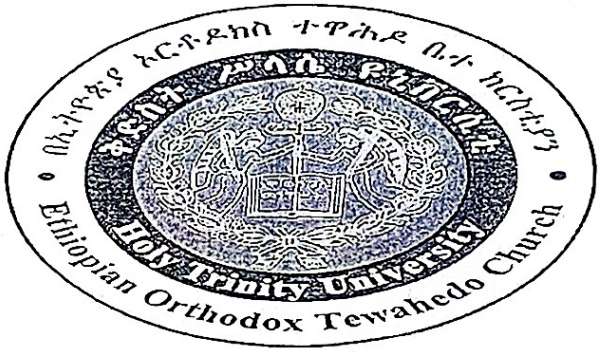
THE HOLY TRINITY UNIVERSTY

Dogma III



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February 2017/2025

Addis Ababa

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Dogma III (Soteriology & Christology)

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Dogma III (Soteriology & Christology)

Christology, the Greek term Χριστός refers to Christ, also known as the Anointed One, and λέξη (lógc) means teaching. The Greek word σωτηρια (sōtēría) means salvation, and the Greek σωτήρ (sōtēr) means Savior. Therefore, in soteriology, we discuss salvation and its appropriation, and in Christology, we discuss the Savior.

The teachings of the early Church Fathers and the Bible serve as the foundation for the Orthodox Church's conception of salvation. According to an Orthodox Christian perspective, salvation is a The core of Orthodox Christian theology is Christology, which is closely related to Orthodox Soteriology. With a focus on the union of God and man in Christ and the restoration of humanity via His incarnation, death, and resurrection, these doctrines center on the nature of Jesus Christ and His redemptive work. In Orthodox Christianity, salvation is a process of healing and restoration rather than just a formal absolution from sin. It is interpreted as a path toward theosis, or union with God, via the work of Christ. Orthodox soteriology's essential components.

The act of Christ's incarnation itself is redemptive. He sanctifies and cures human nature by adopting it. In the eyes of orthodox theology, Christ's crucifixion represents a triumph over sin, death, and the devil (Christus Victor), rather than a penal substitution. The Resurrection is the victory of life over death, which allows people to share in the life of God. Predestination in a deterministic sense is rejected by orthodox soteriology. Rather, it teaches synergy, in which divine grace and human free will work together to save.

Participation in church life, particularly through the Holy Mysteries (Sacraments) of confession, Eucharist, and baptism, is how one experiences salvation. Theosis, or oneness with God, is the ultimate purpose of salvation. Through religious struggle (askesis), faith, and works, this transformation is made possible by God's grace.

The foundation of Orthodox Christology is the conviction that Jesus Christ is both fully God and fully man. According to this doctrine, Christ has one nature from two natters, i.e., both divine and human are united in one person (hypostasis) without confusion, change, division, or separation. Because only a perfect human Christ could fully redeem humanity, and only a perfect divine Christ could defeat sin and death, this understanding is essential for salvation.

Orthodox theology emphasizes theosis (deification)—the idea that Christ took on human nature so that humanity might partake in the divine life. This process, often summarized by St. Athanasius' statement, "God became man so that man might become God", highlights the transformative and

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participatory nature of salvation.Theosis, or deification, is emphasized in orthodox theology as the notion that Christ became human in order for people to share in the divine life. "God became man so that man might part take theoiss by grace instead of taking part in divine nature. This procedure emphasizes the transformative and participatory character of salvation and is frequently summed up by St. Athanasius' assertion that "God became man so that man might become God."

Chapter One

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Dogma III (Soteriology & Christology)

1.Soteriology

1.1 The Creation of man

Soteriology primarily started from the creation and the fall of humans. Because before redemption it should need the presence of Fall. This is emphasized as follows by the EOTC scholar.

"All of us are mortals because we are the body of Adam, who created as our father and died."ተፈጥረ አዳም" አበ ኵሉነ ወሞተ· ወነሕነኒ መሞቲያን እስመ አባሉ· ነሕነ (ሠላሳተ· ዘሐሙስ)

After created in the image of God, Adam ordered to keep : Three orders which issued to him.

1. **Abstain Touching to eat the tree of Knowledge.**
   Gen 2:16-17

   And the Lord God commanded the man, saying, Of every tree of the garden thou mayest freely eat: But of the tree of the knowledge of good and evil, thou shalt not eat of it: for in the day that thou eatest thereof thou shalt surely die.

2. **Keeping the Garden**

   Gen 2:15

   And the Lord God took the man, and put him into the garden of Eden to dress it and to keep it.

3. Worshiping and Praising God

As indicated in the introductory text of the Ethiopian Orthodox Church's traditional calendar reads: "God Created Angels and Man to Worship and Inherit His Kingdom.".
Adam was instructed to exclusively worship and listen to God in the Paradise unlike the creature that attempted to worship itself other than God as was taken from his power.
Isa 14:12
Before fall man's primordial state consisted of four aspects: his unproven holiness, his capacity for opposing choice, his rule over Creation, and his connection with God.

1.2 The fall Man

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The doctrine of human creation, the fall and the saving deeds of the incarnation are fundamental elements of St. Yared' soteriology.[1]

Man abused his moral freedom in the same way that Satan did before him, as did the angels who rebelled with him.

God (cf. Rev 12:2-3; Isa 14:9ff; Eze 28:11ff; 2Pe 2:4 and Jud 6). While living in the angelic life,

Man called to him due to the nature of man:

I. The ability to act in one's own best interests.

II. The ability to distinguish between good and bad.
III . Rewards and Penalties as a result of their actions.
IV. With complete understanding of God's character as a just God.

1.3 The consequence of the fall.

During the Fall the following are broken.

1.3.1 At the Fall of Man, the authority of God was rejected when the serpent asked, "Did God really say…" (Genesis 3:1).

1.3.2 At the Fall of Man, the goodness of God was doubted. When all a person knows God is good, I can see how someone could come in and plant doubts. "*If God was truly good, then why wouldn't he say yes to everything?*" That is at the crux of the serpent's question in Genesis 3.

1.3.3 At the fall of man, the wisdom of God was disputed.

1.3.4 At the Fall of Man, the truth of God was contradicted.

1.3.5 Shame and blame entered the world at the Fall of Man.

1.3.6 Toil entered the world through the Fall of Man. God created humankind to work. Work is a gift God created and he called it good. However, one of the consequences of the Fall of Man was painful toil in every area. Toil means to engage in hard and continuous work and to move with difficulty, weariness, or pain.

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[1] See "ቀዳሚሁ ቃል፡ ነሥአ መሬተ እምድር፡ ወለሐኰ ለአዳም፡ በዘዚአሁ አርአያ ወአምሳል። [The eternal Word took dust from the earth and fashioned Adam in His image and likeness]." St. Yared, BD, 174. "ወአንበርካሁ ውስተ ገነተ ፍሥዕ፡ ወበኂጠተ አርዌ አውጽዕካሁ እምገነት። [You put him in the delightful Paradise. And You expelled him from Paradise upon the deception of the serpent]." St. Yared, BD, 313. "ወሶበ ስዕኑ አድኅኖቶ ለሰብእ እምእደ ሰይጣን፤ ቦ ዘይቤ፡ ፈኑ እዴከ እምአርያም፤ ወቦ ዘይቤ፡ አንሥእ ኃይለከ ወነዓ አድኅነነ፤ ወቦ ዘይቤ፡ እግዚእ እግዚኦ፡ እስከ ማዕአዜኑ፤ ርኢ እግዚኦ ወኢታርምም። ወዘንተ ሰሚያ መሐሪ እግዚአብሔር፡ ፈነወ እምሰማይ መድኃኒተነ፡ ወልዶ ዘያፈቅር፤ አድኅነነ ወቤዘወነ፡ እምተቀንዮ ለጸላዒ። ለጸላዒ። [When they were unable to save humankind from the hands of the devil, there were those that said, 'Send Your Hand from the highest heaven.' And there were those that also said, 'Raise Your power and come and save us.' And others said, 'O Lord, O Lord, for how long?' Look, O Lord and do not be quiet. Having heard this, the merciful God sent our Salvation from heaven. His beloved Son saved us and redeemed us from the oppression of the enemy]." St. Yared, BD, 204. St. Yared, BD, 34, 37.

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1.3.7 The entire human race fell through the Fall of Man.
Romans 5:12-14 tells us that everyone who comes after Adam and Eve inherits physical and spiritual death.

Generally, fall of Adam's resulted with:
Death. Separation from God. When God created Adam, He created him "in his own image" (spiritually and morally perfect) - Gen. 1:26-27; 31, Loss of Grace. Sin Brought to the world. After Adam sinned, his children suffered (Gen. 5:3) (morally corrupt and in need of salvation) Inequality was also became dominant between Man and woman, ...
The fall resulted with the result of total separation from God at the Fall of Man included physical and spiritual death. The latter was immediate, and the former would be eventual.

1.3 Covenant given for the Redemption of the fallen Man.

The EOTC pious and prominent scholar St Yared stressed the way God planned for our salivation in the following manner:

The fall without repentance means eternal which is full of: 1)Hell _ 2) Judgment _ 3) Lake of Fire (Hades - Lk. 16; (Great White Throne - (Rev. 20:14- II Pet. 2:4) Rev. 20:1-13) 15; 21:8

Even though Adam and Eve gave up their intimate union with the Lord, and caused separation from the Lord, he promised hope, through God's mercy, grace, and love for humankind he made a way for us to be reunited in that intimate relationship. God promised to send a redeemer, his Son, who would bridge the separation gap between a holy, righteous God and a sinful, human race, as the indication of the EOTC hymn " *...as He want to support and redeem, the Son of the Father lay over the womb the Virgin.....*" *ፈቲዶ ይርዳኢ መይበሠ መልዶ አብ ውስተ ማኅፀነ ድንግል ኃደረ (የጥር ሥላሴ)*

Adam's salivation Needs God's work alone because:

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Dogma III (Soteriology & Christology)

A. Sin is so deeply committed. B. Adam was not righteous to save himself. c. God's anger toward sin

The Old Testament he Sacrifice had to be:

1. A voluntary sacrifice (Lev.1:3; Jn.10:15,18)

2. A unblemished sacrifice (Exod.12:5; I Pet.1:19)

3. A innocent sacrifice (Heb.7:26-27; II Cor.5:21)

4. A bloody sacrifice (Lev.17:11; Heb.9:22)

5. A vicarious sacrifice (Lev.16:15-22; Is.53:4,5)

6. A satisfying sacrifice (Heb.2:17; Is.53:11)

In order to reestablish the relationship between God and humanity, this full and complete redemption in Jesus Christ must:

- be acceptable and pleasant to God.
- be successful in wiping away sin, as man became separated from God as a result.
- be successful in carrying out God's judgment on sin, since his Word must be fulfilled (see. Ge n 2:16-17; Rom 6:23; Eze 18:4; Num 23:19).
- be successful in disabling the old liar and murderer, Satan (Joh 8:44), who was and is the source of sin (cf. Joh 8:44; Heb 2:14-16; 1Jo 3:8).

OLD TESTAMENT ANNUAL SACRIFICES (One Time Per Year)				
Two Key Days which illustrate the perfect Sacrifice - Jesus Christ, who cleansed us once and for all time				
NAME	RITUAL	SACRIFICE	MEANING	SYMBOL
Passover (Lev. 23:4-5; Exod.12:1-13)	Celebrated on the 14th day of first month. 1) The lamb was w/out blemish (Exod.12:5; I Pet.1:19) 2) The lamb was killed (Exod.12:6; John 12:24,27) 3) The lamb's blood applied (Exod.12:7; Heb.9:22)	Sacrifice was roasted in fire and totally eaten by offerors and families. The blood was sprinkled on the door posts	The deliverance of Christ's sacrifice	Christ is our Passover Lamb (Jn. 1:29; Mt. 26:17- 29; I Cor. 5:7
Yom Kippur	Celebrated on the 10th day of the 7th month. 1) The priest did all the work	One goat was sacrificed	The forgiveness	hrist is our scape goat

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(Day of Atonement) (Lev. 16:1-34)	(cp. Heb. 1:3) 2) The priest offered for himself (v. 11) (Christ didn't need to - Heb. 7:26, 27) 3) Two goats for sin offering: a) 1st goat - slain (v.15-19) b) 2nd goat - sin-bearer (v. 21-22) Christ became our Sin-bearer (Is.53:4,12; I Pet.2:24; Jn.1:29) 4) The blood sprinkled in Holy of Holies (v. 27) (Heb. 9:7, 11-14)	(bearing the penalty of sin). The other goat was led into the wilderness never to be seen again (picturing the removal of sin).	of Christ's sacrifice	who removed our sinl Cor.5:21

Christ became the sinner's substitute so that we would:

1) Have life (Jn. 6:51)

2) Be made righteous (II Cor. 5:21)

3) Be delivered from this present evil world (Gal. 1:4)

4) Be redeemed from the curse of the Law (Gal. 3:13)

5) Be resurrected and raptured to live together with him (I Th. 5:10)

6) Be redeemed from iniquity, purified and zealous (Titus 2:14)

7) Have an example to suffer patiently (I Pet. 2:21, 4:1; cp. I Jn. 3:16) 8) Be brought to God (I Pet. 3:18

The way of salivation for man

A. Faith in the only begotten Son accepting Jesus Christ as the savior. (In the adults' case) *John 3:* 16. For God so loved the world, that he gave his only begotten Son, that whosoever believeth in him should not perish, but have everlasting life.
B. Partaking the Baptism and other sacraments that are mandatory for every Christian. Through baptism we receive the Second Birth which is of water and the Spirit.

I. Baptism washes away sins

This is supported by the final two verses as well as by Ananias' remarks to Saul, who asked, "And now, why are you waiting? Acts 22:16 says, "Arise, and be baptized, and be cleansed from your sins.

II. In baptism there is forgiveness of sins

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The Jews asked St. Peter and the other Apostles on the Day of Pentecost, when they had come to believe and were deeply moved: "Men and brethren, what shall we do?" Repent, and let each of you be baptized in the name of Jesus Christ for the forgiveness of sins, St. Peter and the Apostles said (Acts 2:37,38).

III. Baptism is dying with the Lord Jesus Christ and rising with Him

According to the Bible, "For the wages of sin is death" (Rom. 6:23).

IV. Another Result of baptism is newness of life

The Apostle says: *"Therefore we were buried with Him through baptism into death, that just as Christ was raised from the dead by the glory of the Father, even so we also should walk in newness of life"* (Rom.6: 4).

The Orthodox understanding of salivation depends up on accepting Jesus Christ as a Savior and additionally:

1. continuous process of deification (theosis) attained via sacramental participation, faith in Jesus Christ, and leading a holy life. I Pet 4:17, 1Cor. 10:12

2. Salvation as a Process (combination of of Faith and Works unlike the most protestant Sola fife) Jams 2:17 የማቴዎስ ወንጌል 16:27 የሰው ልጅ ከመላእክቱ ጋር በአባቱ ክብር ይመጣ ዘንድ አለውና፤ ያን ጊዜም ለሁሉ እንደ ሥራው ያስረክበዋል።

የዮሐንስ ራእይ 22:12 እነሆ፥ በቶሎ እመጣለሁ፥ ለእያንዳንዱም እንደ ሥራው መጠን እከፍል ዘንድ ዋጋዬ ከእኔ ጋር አለ።

According to the Orthodox Church, salvation is a continuous process that involves faith, good deeds, and involvement in church sacraments rather than a one-time occurrence. According to St. Paul, believers should "work out your salvation with fear and trembling" (Philippians 2:12, NKJV). This is consistent with Philippians 2:12.

Christ's incarnation was necessary for redemption, according to St. Athanasius, a prominent Coptic Church Father: "God became man so that man might become god."[2]

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[2] (Athanasius, 2011, p. 93). Athanasius. (2011). *On the Incarnation* (J. Behr, Trans.). St. Vladimir's Seminary Press.)

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2. Partaking Sacraments for Salvation Jhon 6:54. Luke 13:5, Jhon 6:14, Jhon 3:5

The Orthodox Church teaches that the Sacraments (Mysteries) play a vital role in salvation, particularly Baptism, Eucharist, and Confession.

- According to John 3:5, baptism is the first step toward salvation and is required for sins to be forgiven.

  - According to Ignatius of Antioch (c. 110 AD), the Eucharist is the "medicine of immortality" and is essential for achieving oneness with Christ (John 6:53–56).
  - When Christians sin, they are restored by confession and repentance (1 John 1:9). The other significant Coptic theologian, St. Cyril of Alexandria, asserts that "we have no life in us unless we partake of the flesh of Christ and Blood." [3]

3. Compatibility Between Human Free Will and Divine Grace

According to St. Severus of Antioch, man must "struggle against sin and actively participate in God's grace," confirming the Orthodox Church's belief that salvation is by God's grace (Ephesians 2:8–9) but also that human cooperation (free will) is necessary.[4]

The Orthodox view of salvation is a lifetime journey of faith, deeds, sacraments, and holiness rather than faith alone (sola fide). The teachings of the Early Church Fathers and Scripture both provide strong foundations for this viewpoint.

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[3] (Cyril of Alexandria, 2006, p. 228). Cyril of Alexandria. (2006). *Commentary on the Gospel of John* (P. Blowers, Trans.). Catholic University of America Press.

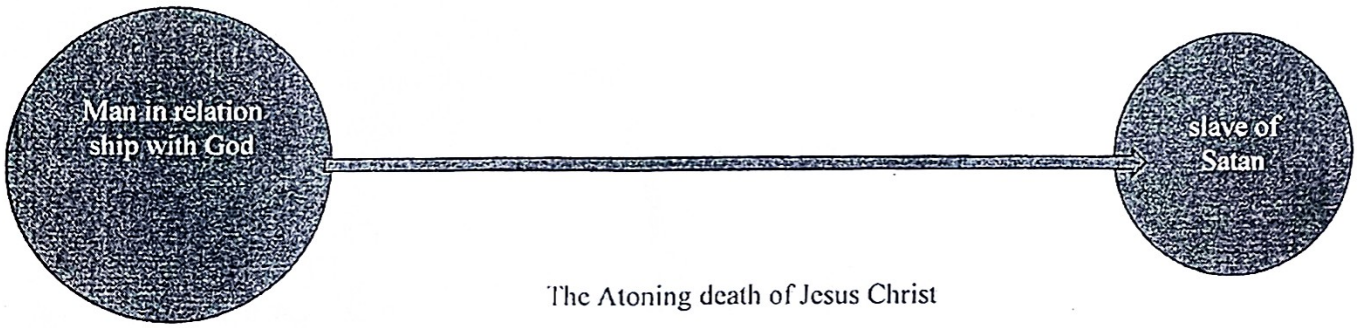
[4] " (Severus of Antioch, 2010, p. 77).Severus of Antioch. (2010). *Letters and Sermons* (S. Brock, Trans.). Gorgias Press.

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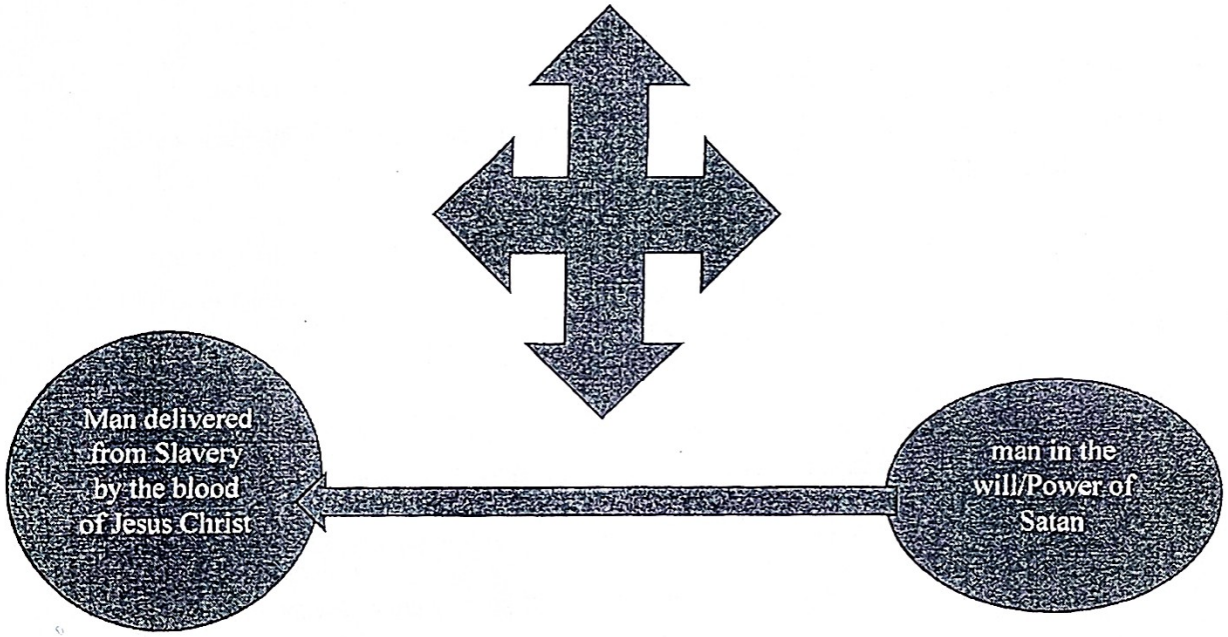
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Through emancipation man separates
himself from God & becomes a .....



The Atoning death of Jesus Christ



From this we conclude: Since the fall, man is by nature separated from God, bound to Satan and spiritually dead: cf. Psa 51:7; Isa 59:2; Eph 2:1.3.[5]

[5] Roland Klege (2015) Christology & Soteriology, P 1.

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Adam committed sin which is against the infinite God, it is consequently regarded as boundless, and as a result, every sin requires infinite redemption.

This atonement should be provided by a person who is:

- Unlimited : In order for the Savior to be able to offer this limitless atonement, he must be sinless. If the Savior were not sinless, He would require redemption in order to be able to save others.
- Human: Since sin was committed by humans, a human being ought to bear the consequences.
- ዮሐንስ 15:13

  ነፍሱን ስለ ወዳጆቹ ከመስጠት ይልቅ ከዚህ የሚበልጥ ፍቅር ለማንም የለውም።
-

Mortal: According to Ram 6:23, the penalty for sin is death, hence the Savior must be mortal. The Son of Man came to serve and to sacrifice His life as a ransom for many, according to what our Lord declared. (Mark 10:45).

St. Paul said, "There is one God and one Mediator between God and men, the Man Christ Jesus, who gave Himself a ransom for all" (1 Timothy 2:5-6). The word 'ransom' suggests some kind of payment and someone to whom this ransom is paid."The ransom was paid to the Divine Justice".

The sacrifices made in the Old Testament served as symbols for the sacrifice made on the cross. Instead of being presented to the devil, these offerings were made to God. Thus, after our father Noah's sacrifice, God "smelled a soothing aroma" (Genesis 8:21), and holy fire descended from heaven and devoured them (1 Kings 18:38). The devil has no right to demand or accept a ransom since sin is an offense against God (Psalm 51:4), and God alone should bear the cost of this transgression. According to Job 1 and Revelations 12:10, the devil is only an accuser. According to Luke 23:46, our Lord surrendered Himself on the cross to the Father rather than the devil.

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The Incarnation of the Logos restored the human nature to its original state and blessed it giving it the potential to fulfill the destiny of its creation; "The Likeness of God".

According to Hebrews 9:22, "without shedding of blood there is no remission," meaning that our Lord's death on the cross satisfied Divine Justice and allowed us to be forgiven of our sins. As a result of people's continued sin, the creation is still moaning and suffering from birth pains (Rom 8:22). However, the wonderful liberty of God's children will be granted to it, freeing it from the bonds of corruption (Rom 8:21). In the Holy Book of Revelation, St. John states that "I saw a new heaven and a new earth, for the first heaven and the first earth had passed away" (Revelation 21:4).

Unlike Lutherans who holds doctrine of five soles i.e sola fide (faith alone), sola scriptura (Scripture alone), solus Christus (Christ alone), sola gratia (grace alone), and soli Deo gloria (glory to God alone), human salivation needs each individual involvement for his/her sake due to :

1. The essentiality of human response. Lord knocks the door and the should open it.
   Rev. 3:20
   [….."Behold, I stand at the door, and knock: if any man hear my voice, and open the door, I will come in to him, and will sup with him, and he with me…. "እነሆ በደጅ ቆሜ አንኳኳለሁ፤ ማንም ድምፄን ቢሰማ ደጁንም ቢከፍትልኝ፥ ወደ እርሱ እገባለሁ ከእርሱም ጋር እራት እበላለሁ እርሱም ከእኔ ጋር ይበላል።….]
2. God never interfere in the human free will. So the salivation of human depends up of in his/her own will.
   Jhon 5:6
   […When Jesus saw him lie, and knew that he had been now a long time in that case, he saith unto him, Wilt thou be made whole? ኢየሱስ ይህን ሰው ተኝቶ ባየ ጊዜ፥ እስከ አሁን ብዙ ዘመን እንዲሁ እንደ ነበረ አውቆ፦ ልትድን ትወዳለህን? አለው።….]
   In the covenant of salivation there two parties. God Is the First Party in the covenant. He established the covenant and determines the relation in which the second party will stand to Him. Man is the Second Party to the covenant granted to him/her.
   I. Faith in the only begotten Son accepting Jesus Christ as the savior. (In the adults' case)

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Dogma III (Soteriology & Christology)

The key Features of ROTC Soteriology

- Salivation without incarnation is impossible.
- Jesus Christ is the only way for our Salivation.
- Salivation is not the time occasion instead it is a lifelong process.
- Faith, grace and good deeds are the essential elements of for salivation.
- Interaction of saints is an essential for Christians in earthly life.
-

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II. Christology

II.1 Introduction

Within the EOTC, the theological understanding of Christ is called "Christology." It is founded on the teachings of the early Church Fathers, the decisions of the early Ecumenical Councils, and the theological contributions of figures such as St. Cyril of Alexandria and St. Athanasius of Alexandria's time.

The theological understanding of Christ within the EOTC is known as "Christology." It is based on the teachings of the early Church Fathers, the decisions of the early Ecumenical Councils, and the theological contributions made by individuals like St. Cyril of Alexandria and St. Athanasius of Alexandria's time.

Christology of St. Cyril of Alexandria: μία φύσις τοῦ Θεοῦ Λόγου σεσαρκωμένη ("One nature of the Incarnate Word of God. It differs from both doxophysitism, which sees two separate natures (divine and human) in Christ, and monophysitism, which holds that Christ has just one (divine) nature.

Christ was described as having two separate natures by the Council of Chalcedon, which the EOTC denied.This caused the Chalcedonian churches (including the Eastern Orthodox and Roman Catholic churches) to split from the Oriental Orthodox churches (including the Coptic, Armenian, Syriac, Ethiopian, and Indian Orthodox churches).The EOTC position upholds a perfect oneness between Christ's divinity and humanity, while our Church considers that the Chalcedonian definition could suggest a separation.

The EOTC stressed St. Cyril's Christology who proposed that Christ is one Person and one Nature, without of division or confusion. According to the EOTC, Salvation depends on the oneness of Christ's nature as Christ took on all of mankind in order to save it.In order to purify and bring people closer to God, his divine nature remained completely present.

The EOTC teaches that Christians are reunited with God through the death and resurrection of Christ. Christ's divinity and humanity as one cohesive reality are emphasized in EOTC hymns and liturgy. According to the mystical theology of the Church, participating in the Eucharist entails

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sharing in Christ's one essence. Emphasizing the whole oneness of Christ's divine and human essence, EOTC's Christology has its roots in the teachings of the early Church. It has always been essential to the identity of the EOT C's and continues to be a distinctive characteristic of Oriental Orthodox theology.

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II.2 The essence of Orthodox Christology

Christology is the Theological study of the person, nature, and work of Jesus Christ. It explores His identity, mission, and role in salvation. The main elements of Christology include:

- **Divinity of Christ** – Jesus as fully God (John 1:1, Colossians 2:9). the Divinty of Jesus was *consubstantial* (homoousios) with The Fathe and the Holy Sprit's divinity .
- **Humanity of Christ** – Jesus as fully human (Philippians 2:6-8, Hebrews 4:15). the humanity of Jesus was *consubstantial* (homoousios) with our humanity apart from sin.

II.3 Jesus Christ is the 2nd Adam who is Ransom for the 1st Adam

First Adam	The Lord Jesus
Followed His feelings and instincts.	Followed the commands of God the Father.
Defied death and believed the Serpent.	Died for our Sin and accepted death.
Wanted to Be independent From God	Always Fulfilled the Will of the Father.
Wanted to Be Like God.	Gave God Full Glory.

II.4 Jesus Christ perfect man and Perfect God

The Lord Jesus True Man	**The Lord Jesus True God**
He Said Didn't Know the Day of Final Judgment Mark 13:32 "But of that day and hour no	He knows Every Thing John 21:17 He said to him the third time, "Simon, son of Jonah, do you love Me?"

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one knows, not even the angels in heaven, nor the Son, but only the Father	Peter was grieved because He said to him the third time, "Do you love Me?" And he said to Him, "Lord, You know all things; You know that I love You." Jesus said to him, "Feed My sheep.
Prayed Luke 22:41-42 And He was withdrawn from them about a stone's throw, and He knelt down and prayed, 42 saying, "Father, if it is Your will, take this cup away from Me; nevertheless not My will, but Yours, be done."	Answers Our Prayers John 14:13-14 "And whatever you ask in My name, that I will do, that the Father may be glorified in the Son. "If you ask anything in My name, I will do it.
He was Troubled John 13:21 When Jesus had said these things, He was troubled in spirit, and testified and said,	Who Believe in Him Removes Trouble John 14:1 "Let not your heart be troubled; you
Died John 19:30 So when Jesus had received the sour wine, He said, "It is finished!" And bowing His head, He gave up His spirit.	Raised Himself and Raises others From Death John 11:25 Jesus said to her, "I am the resurrection and the life. He who believes in Me, though he may die, he shall live
He said The Father is Greater Than Him John 14:28 "You have heard Me say to you, 'I am going away and coming back to you.' If you loved Me, you would rejoice because I said, 'I am going to the Father,' for My Father	Declared Himself Equal to The Father John 5:18 Therefore the Jews sought all the more to kill Him, because He not only broke the Sabbath, but also said that God was His Father, making Himself equal with God
Was Hungry Luke 4:2 being tempted for forty days by the devil.And in those days He ate	Fed the Multitudes Refer to John 6:5

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II. Partaking the Baptism and other sacraments that are mandatory for every Christian.

C. Practicing Prayer, fasting and Love.

Matt 26:41

Watch and pray, that ye enter not into temptation: the spirit indeed is willing, but the flesh is weak.

Luke 2: 37

And she was a widow of about fourscore and four years, which departed not from the temple, but served God with fastings and prayers night and day.

Matt 17: 21

Howbeit this kind goeth not out but by prayer and fasting.

View of Early Church Father On Soteriology

In his epistle to the Corinthians, Clement of Rome (c. 35–99 AD) stressed both the need for good deeds and redemption by God's mercy.He advised us keep looking firmly at Christ's blood and see how valuable it is in God's eyes. His blood was shed for our redemption and extended the invitation to repentance to everyone on the planet. Furthermore, Paul underlined in 1 Clement 7:4 that we are justified by the faith that Almighty God has used to justify all people from the beginning, not by our own goodness, wisdom, knowledge, or actions of holiness toward others. [6]

Ignatius of Antioch (c. 35–107 AD) emphasized adherence to the Church and trust in Christ. Ignatius states, if Christians continue to live in accordance with Judaism, they acknowledge that they have not received grace... It is ridiculous to profess Jesus Christ and to Judaize. If Christians are to be considered Christians, they must be more than just called Christians.[7]

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[6] (1 Clement 32:4) *1 Clement*, translated in *The Apostolic Fathers*, ed. J. B. Lightfoot

[7] *The Epistles of St. Ignatius*, ed. and trans. J.B. Lightfoot

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Dogma III (Soteriology & Christology)

Justin Martyr (c. 100–165 AD) stressed the importance of good deeds but also highlighted Christ's atonement and faith. According to him, no rational person would argue that we may gain God's favor by paying blood; instead, we believe in Christ's atoning act, which is used for both the pursuit of righteousness and the forgiveness of previous sins. (Trypho's Dialogue 95) He also holds that we are justified by our deeds, but not by our own deeds but rather by everything we have done through Christ's authority. [8]

Augustine of Hippo (354–430 AD) emphasized the importance of grace in salvation, saying that we are saved by grace and not by ourselves, and that even our good deeds are a result of God's grace within us (On Grace and Free Will 17.33). He also added that if someone claims that God's grace is bestowed because of our merits, he is contradicting the apostle who states, "If by grace, then it is no more of works; otherwise grace is no more grace.[9]

God has given men salvation through His own Son, so that by faith we might be justified not by the works of the Law but by grace. Irenaeus of Lyons (c. 130–202 AD) highlighted the role of Christ's incarnation and obedience in salvation. He set the Word of God, our Lord Jesus Christ, who became what we are through His transcendent love in order to bring us to be even what He is Himself.[10]

According to Clement of Alexandria (c. 150–215 AD), salvation is by faith, but faith is demonstrated by deeds.If we are baptized, we are enlightened; if we are adopted, we are made perfect; if we are made perfect, we are immortal, according to him.He asserts that knowledge of God is the first step toward salvation and that it is God's wish for us to do so.[11]

(Epistle to the Magnesians 8:1),*Epistle to the Magnesians* 4:1)

[8] (*First Apology* 61) *Justin Martyr: First and Second Apologies*, trans. Leslie William Barnard

[9] (*Epistle to Simplician* 1.2.12) *Augustine: On Grace and Free Will*, trans. P. Holmes

[10] *Against Heresies*, trans. A. Roberts & J. Donaldson

[11] *Clement of Alexandria: The Instructor*, trans. Simon Wood

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Conclusion

The early Christian tradition and Holy Scripture are the foundation of soteriology, or the theology of salvation, which emphasizes how Christ's work transformed mankind and brought it back into harmony with God as illustrated as the main tenets of soteriology:
The Orthodox Church holds that salvation is about deification (theosis), or being one with God by Christ, rather than merely avoiding sin and punishment. This is founded on the idea that Christians become "partakers of the divine nature," as stated in 2 Peter 1:4.

The Incarnation is central to salvation. The Church Fathers, especially **St. Athanasius**, emphasized that **"God became man so that man might become god"** (On the Incarnation). Through His death and resurrection, Christ destroyed death and sin, granting humanity a path back to God.Salvation revolves around the Incarnation. It was stressed by the Church Fathers, particularly St. Athanasius, that "God became man so that man might become god" (On the Incarnation." Christ's death and resurrection provided a way for people to return to God by destroying sin and death.

Participating in the sacraments is a lifetime process that leads to salvation rather than a one-time event: Which are Baptism is admission into the new life in Christ as demonstrated in the Bible (John 3:5).Chrismation is also getting the Holy Spirit to advance one's spirituality. As indicated in o John 6:53–56, the eucharist is the genuine presence of Christ that sustains and feeds the believer. The other sacrament which is confession and repentance is an ongoing reconciliation and cleansing in Christ. The Orthodox Church maintains that human free choice and God's grace are in coherence. Humans must respond with faith, repentance, and obedience, even when salvation is started by God's grace (Philippians 2:12-13).

Through apostolic tradition and teachings, the Church serves as the New Testament Ark, nurturing, protecting, and guiding Christians toward salvation. According to soteriology, salvation is a comprehensive process that includes spiritual struggle, sacraments, faith, and divine grace. It is transformative (restoring humanity's divine image) rather than just legalistic (justification). Believers are called into an everlasting relationship with God, which leads to eternal life, via the incarnation, death, and resurrection of Christ.

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nothing, and afterward, when they had ended, He was hungry.	
JEHOVAH GOD DECLARES (ISA 44:6)- "Thus says the Lord, the King of Israel, and his Redeemer, the Lord of hosts: `I {am} the First and I {am} the Last; besides Me {there is} no God. (NKJ)	THE LORD JESUS ACCEPTS WORSHIP(JOH 20:28)- And Thomas answered and said to Him, "My Lord and my God!" (NKJ). Revel. 22:13

The Bible makes it very evident that although our Lord and Savior Jesus Christ is a real man, He is also a true God.
He said that he was God; he had the attributes of God; he performs the actions of God; and he is known as God.

The Bible makes it very evident that although our Lord and Savior Jesus Christ is a real man, He is also a true God.
He said that he was God; he had the attributes of God; he performs the actions of God; and he is known as God.

Jesus Christ is the following:

- **Messiah** :-The Anointed One (Matthew 16:16).
- **Son of God** – His divine sonship (John 3:16).
- **Son of Man** – His human nature and fulfillment of prophecy (Daniel 7:13, Mark 10:45).
- **Lord** – His authority and divinity (Philippians 2:11).

II.6 Our Lord and Savior Jesus Christ Fulfulded & will fulfil:

Incarnation – God becoming flesh (John 1:14)

Atonement – His sacrificial death for the sins of humanity (Romans 3:25, 1 John 2:2).

Resurrection – His victory over death (1 Corinthians 15:3-4).

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Ascension – His exaltation and role as intercessor (Acts 1:9-11, Hebrews 7:25).**Second Coming** – His return in glory (Matthew 24:30, Revelation 19:11-16).

The EOTC understands Jesus Christ in Holy Trinity as :

Relationship to the Father – Jesus as the eternal Son (John 10:30).

Role of the Holy Spirit – Jesus empowered by and sending the Spirit (John 14:26).

Pre-existence of Christ – Christ existed before creation (John 17:5, Colossians 1:16-17).

As an Oriental Church member, the EOTC's Christology is based on the teachings of the early Church Fathers, especially St. Cyril of Alexandria (376–444 AD). It is characterized by the Miaphysite doctrine, which highlights Christ's one and only nature—fully human and fully divine—without distinction, confusion, or change.

In summary, the Coptic Orthodox Church adheres to the Miaphysite Christological formula, which holds that Christ is "one incarnate nature of God the Word" (μία φύσις τοῦ Θεοῦ Λόγου σεσαρκωμένη). This doctrine contrasts with the Dyophysite position held by the Chalcedonian Churches, which maintains that Christ exists in two distinct natures—one divine and one human.

II.7 Miaphysitism , Monophysitism and Dyophysitism

Following the Council of Chalcedon (451 AD), the main Christological disagreement emerged between the Chalcedonian and non-Chalcedonian churches. Christ is believed to exist "in two natures," according to the Chalcedonian Definition. However, the Oriental Orthodox Churches rejected this definition since it implied that Christ's person was divided. Oriental Orthodox theology, on the other hand, adopts St. Cyril's statement, which characterizes Christ as having a single essence that is both completely human and totally divine.

II.7.1 Miaphysitism (μία φύσις)

The Oriental Orthodox Churches (such as the Coptic, Armenian, Syriac, Ethiopian, and Eritrean Orthodox Churches) uphold the teachings of Cyril of Alexandria, which holds that Christ has one united, composite nature (μία φύσις θεοῦ λόγου σεσαρκωμένη – "one nature of the incarnate

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Word of God"), in which His divinity and humanity are fully present without confusion, change, division, or separation. It rejects both Nestorianism, which divides Christ into two persons, and Monophysitism, which absorbs humanity into divinity. The Council of Chalcedon (451) rejected this view, interpreting it as being too close to Monophysitism, but Miaphysite churches contend that Chalcedon misinterpreted their theology.

II.7.2 Monophysitism (μόνη φύσις)

An extreme response to Nestorianism, more radical than Eutyches' Miaphysitism. claims that Christ is a single being whose humanity has become mired in His divinity ("like a drop of water in the ocean").

The Council of Chalcedon (451) declared this to be heretical as it rejected Christ's whole humanity. Although the term was first used incorrectly to refer to the Oriental Orthodox, no significant Christian tradition now considers itself to be Monophysite.

Feature	Miaphysitism	Monophysitism
View of Christ's Nature	One united nature, fully divine and fully human	One single divine nature absorbing the human
prominent Figure	Cyril of Alexandria	Eutyches
Accepted by	Oriental Orthodox Churches	Condemned as heretical
Council Stance	Rejected by Chalcedonians,	Anathematized by all Churches

Christology in the Oriental Orthodox Churches is based on the ideas of St. Cyril of Alexandria, who emphasized that after the Incarnation, Christ's divinity and humanity were united in a single nature. His famous 12 Anathemas against Nestorius played a significant role in the development of this Christology, especially in rejecting the idea that Christ had two distinct persons or natures.

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The EOTC's liturgical and theological traditions consistently refer to Christ as the "one incarnate nature of the Word of God."

The Anaphora of St. Dioscorus, which stresses Christ as the "one united nature of the Word of God" and represents Miaphysite theology, is a unique liturgical element of EOTC Christology. [12]

The EOTC holds the Virgin Mary in the highest regard, highlighting her part in the mystery of the Incarnation and acknowledging her as "Theotokos" (God-bearer). Ethiopian Christology incorporates the theology of the Ark of the Covenant and St. Mary in a unique way, connecting the Old Testament symbolism with the nature of Christ. [13]

The Book of Enoch and Jubilees are two examples of the larger canon that the EOTC draws upon to support its distinctive Christological viewpoints. [14]

These texts emphasize the divine nature of Christ as preexistent and eternal, harmonizing with the Church's Miaphysite stance.[15]

II.8 The Early Church Fathers on the Divinity of Jesus Christ

The divinity of Jesus Christ was a central doctrine upheld by the Early Church Fathers, who defended this belief against various heresies and provided theological foundations for later doctrinal formulations. Several prominent Church Fathers, including Ignatius of Antioch, Justin Martyr, Irenaeus of Lyons, and Athanasius of Alexandria, explicitly affirmed Jesus' divine nature.

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[12] Habtemichael, G. (2018). *Liturgy and Theology in the Ethiopian Orthodox Church*. Nairobi: Pauline Publications.

[13] Kaplan, S. (2004). *The Ethiopian Orthodox Church and its Traditions*. Trenton: Red Sea Press.

[14] Getachew, M. (2015). *The Role of the Book of Enoch in Ethiopian Christianity*. Addis Ababa: University Press.

[15] Wondmagegnehu, G., & Motovu, P. (1970). *The Ethiopian Orthodox Church*. Addis Ababa: Berhanena Selam Press.

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II,8,1 Ignatius of Antioch (c. 35–110 AD)

Ignatius of Antioch, an early bishop and martyr, strongly affirmed Christ's divinity in his epistles. In his *Letter to the Ephesians*, he refers to Jesus Christ as "our God" (Ignatius, c. 110/1999). He also states in *Letter to the Smyrnaeans*, "I give glory to Jesus Christ, the God who has made you wise". His writings demonstrate an early and explicit recognition of Christ's divine status.[16]

II.8.2 Justin Martyr (c. 100–165 AD)

Justin Martyr, one of the first Christian apologists, argued for Christ's divinity using philosophical and Scriptural reasoning. In his *First Apology*, he describes Christ as the preexistent Logos (Word) who was with God and is God, drawing from John 1. He also defends Christ as the divine Son who was worshiped alongside the Father.[17]

II.8.3 Irenaeus of Lyons (c. 130–202 AD)

Irenaeus, in his seminal work *Against Heresies*, defends the divinity of Christ against Gnostic heresies. He declares that Jesus is "God, for the name Emmanuel indicates this" (Irenaeus, c. 180/1885, 3.16.3). He also affirms Christ's role in creation, stating that all things were made through Him, reinforcing His divine nature.[18]

II.8.4 St. Athanasius of Alexandria (c. 296–373 AD)

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[16] Ignatius of Antioch. (1999). *The epistles of St. Ignatius* (K. Lake, Trans.). Harvard University Press. (Original work published c. 110)

[17] Justin Martyr. (2007). *First apology* (D. Minns & P. Parvis, Trans.). Oxford University Press. (Original work published c. 155)

[18] Irenaeus of Lyons. (1885). *Against heresies* (A. Roberts & J. Donaldson, Trans.). In P. Schaff (Ed.), *Ante-Nicene Fathers, Volume 1*. Christian Literature Publishing Co. (Original work published c. 180)

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Dogma III (Soteriology & Christology)

St. Athanasius was a key defender of Christ's divinity during the Arian controversy. In *On the Incarnation*, he argues that Christ, as the divine Logos, took on human flesh to redeem humanity (Athanasius, c. 318/2011). His theological defense played a crucial role in the formulation of Nicene Christology.[19]

The Early Church Fathers consistently affirmed the divinity of Jesus Christ through their theological writings and defenses against heresies. Their contributions laid the foundation for the doctrine of the Trinity and Christology, later formalized at the Council of Nicaea in 325 AD.

In Ethiopian Christianity, two notable figures are St. Yared and Abba Giorgis. Who are important in their own way, their contributions to Christology are also related as those the Ethiopian Christian tradition, which has its roots in Orthodox Christology, can be better understood through their lives and teachings.

An important figure in Ethiopian Christianity, Abba Giorgis, who is also referred to as St. George in many Christian traditions. His connection to Christology is more rooted in his status as a martyr and a beloved saint—often portrayed as a warrior saint—than in his theological teachings. St. George is frequently depicted battling a dragon in Ethiopian iconography, signifying the conflict between good and evil and illustrating his protective function within the Church.

Like other Eastern Orthodox churches, the Ethiopian Orthodox Church subscribes to a Christological belief system based on Miaphysitism, which holds that Christ is both fully human and fully divine in one single nature. As a person revered in this context, St. George would be interpreted within the same theological framework, contributing to the comprehension of Christ's role as savior and redeemer as well as his unity of nature.

Like other Eastern Orthodox churches, the Ethiopian Orthodox Church subscribes to a Christological belief system based on Miaphysitism, which holds that Christ is both fully human and fully divine in one single nature. As a person revered in this context, St. George would be interpreted within the same theological framework, contributing to the comprehension of Christ's role as savior and redeemer as well as his unity of nature.

[19] Athanasius. (2011). *On the incarnation* (J. Behr, Trans.). St. Vladimir's Seminary Press. (Original work published c. 318)

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Rather than his contributions to Christology, St. Yared (c. 505–571 AD) is best known for being the creator of Ethiopian liturgical music and hymns. His contributions to the development of the Ethiopian Orthodox Church's traditional chants, particularly the musical notation known as "Zema," had a significant influence on the Church's worship rituals. But St. Yared's conception of Christ would be based on the Christology of the larger Ethiopian Orthodox Church, which is consistent with Miaphysitism. According to this doctrine, Christ is "one united nature" (derived from the Greek words "physis" for "nature" and "mia" for "one"). The Council of Chalcedon (451 AD) formalized this doctrine, but the Ethiopian Church adopted the Miaphysite view, which stresses the unity of Christ's nature, instead of accepting the council's definition.

II.9 Are Incarnation & Christology the same?

The ideas of Christology and Incarnation are central to Christian theology, but they focus on various facets of Jesus Christ's person and mission; they are connected, but their theological emphasis is different.

II.9. 1 Incarnation

The *Incarnation* refers to the belief that Jesus Christ, who is fully divine, took on human nature and became man. This doctrine is rooted in John 1:14, which states, *"The Word became flesh and made his dwelling among us"* . The Incarnation affirms that Jesus is both fully God and fully human, a belief that was formally defined at the Council of Chalcedon in 451 AD , It is central to Christian soteriology, as it establishes the foundation for Jesus' role as the mediator between God and humanity .

II.9.2 Christology

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On the other hand, *Christology* is the broader theological study of the person, nature, and work of Jesus Christ. It encompasses doctrines such as the Incarnation, the hypostatic union (the union of divine and human natures in Christ), the atonement, and the resurrection . Christology examines various perspectives on Jesus' identity, including high Christology (which emphasizes his divinity) and low Christology (which focuses on his humanity) .

To indicate the key difference:

1. Subject matter: Christology is a large subject of study, yet incarnation is a specific belief within it.
2. Concentration: Christology examines every facet of Jesus' character and purpose, whereas the Incarnation focuses mainly on his taking on human flesh.
3. Theological Implications: Christology offers a framework for analyzing Jesus' place in Christian history and faith, while the Incarnation is crucial to comprehending Christ's redemptive mission.

4.Almost no disagreement between all Christian denominations concerning Incarnation whereas, in Christological view there are dispute and argument. See tge case of Tsega, Qibat and Tewahido conflict in the Gondrian era in Ethiopia.

Generally , one of the major ideas of Christology is the Incarnation. The Incarnation is one of the fundamental ideas of Christology, which examines the full person and work of Christ.

II. 10 Holy Scripture's testimony about Jesus Christ

II.10.1 On Divinity of Jesus Christ

John 1:1, 14 – *"In the beginning was the Word, and the Word was with God, and the Word was God... The Word became flesh and made his dwelling among us. We have seen his glory, the glory of the one and only Son, who came from the Father, full of grace and truth."*

Colossians 2:9 – *"For in Christ all the fullness of the Deity lives in bodily form."*

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Hebrews 1:3 -- *"The Son is the radiance of God's glory and the exact representation of his being, sustaining all things by his powerful word."*

John 10:30 -- *"I and the Father are one."*

Philippians 2:5-6 -- *"In your relationships with one another, have the same mindset as Christ Jesus: Who, being in very nature God, did not consider equality with God something to be used to his own advantage."*

II.10.2 On the Humanity of Jesus Christ

John 1:14 – *"The Word became flesh and made his dwelling among us."*

Hebrews 2:17 – *"For this reason he had to be made like them, fully human in every way, in order that he might become a merciful and faithful high priest in service to God, and that he might make atonement for the sins of the people."*

Timothy 2:5 – *"For there is one God and one mediator between God and mankind, the man Christ Jesus.*

"Luke 2:52 – *"And Jesus grew in wisdom and stature, and in favor with God and man."*
Matthew 4:2 *"After fasting forty days and forty nights, he was h ungry."*

Oriental Orthodox Christology is rooted in the teachings of the early Church, particularly as defined by the Ecumenical Councils. It affirms that Jesus Christ is fully God and fully man, united in one person without confusion, change, division, or separation. Christology in EOTC is based on Scripture and Holy Tradition.

The Hypostatic Union is the doctrine that two natures before incarnation (Divinity and Humanity) in Jesus Christ, exist in one person and nature (hypostasis). This is a key doctrine in oriental Orthodox theology, distinguishing it from heresies that either divide or make two natures after incarnation. As indicated by Gregory of Nazianzus Christ possesses the fullness of divine nature.[20]

[20] Schaff. Nicene and Post Nicene Fathers (Gregory of Nazianzus, Orations 29.19).

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and as affirmed by Jhon of Damascus Our Lord possesses Fully Human: Christ assumed true human nature, including body and soul.[21]

The concept of "One incarnate nature of the Word of God" was first defined by St. Cyril of Alexandria. [22] TO Oriental Orthodoxy the Theotokos is crucial in understanding Christology . The Orthodox Church honors the ever-Blessed Verigin Mary as **Theotokos** (Θεοτόκος, "God-bearer"), affirming that she gave birth to Christ, who is fully God and fully man to combat Nestorianism. Denying her title risks separating Christ's divinity from His humanity from His humanity

The Term Theotokia was confirmed at the council of Ephesus (431 AD) to combat Nestorianism.

Oriental Orthodox Theology is based on :

Theosis (deification), the process of humanity being united with God through Christ as confirmed by St. St. Athanasius: "God became man so that man might become god".[23]

Salvation is not just juridical (legal atonement) but a restoration of human nature through Christ's Incarnation, Crucifixion, and Resurrection.

Heresy	Mistake	**Orthodox Response**
Arianism	Christ is not fully divine (Subordinate to the Father)	Council of Nicaea (325) affirmed Christ's full divinity
Nestorianism	Christ is two persons	Council of Ephesus (431) affirmed **Theotokos** and Christ's unity
Monophysitism	Christ has only one nature (divine)	
Monothelitism	Christ has only one will	

John of Damascus, 1898/1958

[21] Schaff. Nicene and Post Nicene Fathers (John of Damascus, 1898/1958

[22] Schaff. Nicene and Post Nicene Fathers (Cyril of Alexandria, *Letters*, 45.9).

[23] Schaff. Nicene and Post Nicene Fathers (*On the Incarnation*, 54).

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Dogma III (Soteriology & Christology)

II.11 Jesus Christ in the Old Testament

II.11.1 Prophecies

Genesis 3:15 God states in the first prophecy of the Messiah that the serpent's head will be crushed by the woman's seed.

Isaiah 7:14 – As stated in Matthew 1:23, a virgin will conceive and give birth to a son named Immanuel ("God with us").

Isaiah 9:6-7 – says that the child will grow up to be known as a "Wonderful Counselor, Mighty God, Everlasting Father, Prince of Peace."

Micah 5:2 – forecasts the birth of the Messiah in Bethlehem.

Psalm 22 – An indicative prophecy of Jesus' crucifixion that details specifics fulfilled on the cross.

Isaiah 53 – explains the suffering servant, a prophecy that was realized through the selfless death of Jesus Christ.

II. 11.2 Jesus Christ Viewed in OT as:

Adam – Jesus is called the "2nd Adam" (1 Corinthians 15:45), representing a new humanity.

Melchizedek (Genesis 14:18-20) – A priest and king who prefigures Christ's eternal priesthood (Hebrews 7).

The Passover Lamb (Exodus 12) – Foreshadows Jesus as the Lamb of God (John 1:29).

The Bronze Serpent (Numbers 21:9) – Jesus refers to this as a symbol of His crucifixion (John 3:14-15).

The Manna from Heaven (Exodus 16) – Jesus calls Himself the "Bread of Life" (John 6:31-35).

The Rock in the Wilderness (Exodus 17:6) – Paul says this rock, which provided water, symbolized Christ (1 Corinthians 10:4).

Jonah – Jesus compares His death and resurrection to Jonah's three days in the fish (Matthew 12:40).

Genesis 18 – Abraham is visited by three men, one of whom is often interpreted as the Lord.

Genesis 32:24-30 – Jacob wrestles with a "man" who is later identified as God.

II.12 Jesus Christ's testimony about Himself.

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Dogma III (Soteriology & Christology)

"I am the Bread of Life" (John 6:35, 48, 51)

Jesus offers eternal life and spiritual sustenance.

"I am the Light of the World" (John 8:12)

Jesus dispels spiritual darkness by bringing wisdom and truth.

"I am the Door" (or Gate) of the Sheep (John 10:7, 9)

The only way to salvation and safety is by means of Jesus.

"I am the Good Shepherd" (John 10:11, 14)

Like a shepherd tends to his sheep, Jesus looks out for and defends His followers.

"I am the Resurrection and the Life" (John 11:25)

Jesus has power over life and death, offering eternal life.

"I am the Way, the Truth, and the Life" (John 14:6)

The only way to reach God the Father is with Jesus.

"I am the True Vine" (John 15:1, 5)

Spiritual life comes from Jesus, and His disciples need to maintain their relationship with Him.

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II.13 Conclusion

Christology is the study of Jesus Christ's life, nature, and mission. Theological viewpoints influence the conclusions that can be drawn from Christology.Christology confirms that Jesus is the promised Messiah (Christ), who, by His life, death, and resurrection, saves humanity and carries out Old Testament prophecies. Christian theology places a strong emphasis on Jesus' atoning sacrifice on the cross, which is seen as a way to make reconciliation between God and humanity. For believers, his resurrection offers eternal life as a sign of victory over sin and death. According to Christology, Jesus is an exception within the Trinity, coequal with the Father and the Holy Spirit. Jesus shows humanity the nature, love, and will of God through His teachings, healings, and life.

Jesus Christ will return in the future to fully establish God's kingdom and bring about the final judgment. Christology affirms that the core of the Christian faith is Jesus Christ, who shapes discipleship, worship, and theology. Christians' faith and relationship with God are strengthened by their continued theological reflection on His identity and mission.

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Dogma III (Soteriology & Christology)

The doctrine of Miaphysitism, which maintains that Jesus Christ has one united nature (physis) out of two—divine and human—is the foundation of Oriental Orthodox Christology. After the Council of Chalcedon (451 AD), which the Oriental Orthodox Churches rejected and thus split from the the Roman Catholic and Eastern Orthodox Church.

Cyril of Alexandria's Miaphysitism—which emphasizes a single, united nature that is fully divine and fully human—is upheld by Oriental Orthodox theology.In contrast, Christ is described by the Chalcedonian Definition as having two separate natures (Dyophysitism), human and divine, combined into one person.

Eutychian Monophysitism, which holds that Christ's human nature was assimilated into His divine nature, is not accepted by the Oriental Orthodox Church.Rather, they affirm that His divinity and humanity are one and that they are not confused, changed divided, or separated. Oriental Orthodoxy maintains a Christology that emphasizes one nutere for Jesus Christ in accordance with the teachings of St. Athanasius and St. Cyril of Alexandria.

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